

B.Ed. 1st Semester — Course 1.1.EPC-1 (Reading and Reflecting on Texts)

Compiled Question Bank with Model Answers (2020–2024 papers)

This course has only two groups — Group A (2 marks) and Group B (5 marks), Full Marks 25. Repeated questions are listed once with all years they appeared. Answers are written in points, in easy English, within the prescribed word limits.

GROUP A — 2 Marks Questions (Answer within 50 words)

1. What is the full form of EPC? (2023)

EPC stands for "Enhancing Professional Capacities." It is a practicum-based course in the B.Ed. curriculum designed to develop specific professional and academic skills, such as reading, reflection, and communication, needed by a teacher.

2. Mention two advantages of Oral / Loud Reading. (2020, 2022)

- It improves pronunciation, fluency, and correct intonation of words.
- It helps the reader (and listeners) understand and retain information better, as it engages auditory senses along with visual reading.

3. What do you mean by 'creative reading'? (2020, 2022)

Creative reading is an imaginative, open-minded way of reading where the reader goes beyond literal meaning. It involves exploring different perspectives, making personal connections, and generating new ideas or insights while engaging with the text.

4. What do you mean by Expository texts? (2020)

Expository texts are written to explain, describe, or inform readers about a topic using facts, definitions, and examples. Textbooks, articles, and reports are common examples, as their main purpose is to present information clearly and logically.

5. Write two / four characteristics of good / ideal reading. (2020, 2024)

- Good reading is fluent, accurate, and done at an appropriate speed without unnecessary pauses.
- It shows proper comprehension — the reader understands and can explain the meaning of the text, along with correct pronunciation and expression.

6. What is the meaning of 'meta-cognition' / 'Metacognition for reading'? (2020, 2022)

Metacognition for reading means being aware of and controlling one's own thinking while reading. It involves monitoring one's understanding, setting reading goals, and using strategies to improve comprehension while reading a text.

7. What do you mean by decoding? (2020)

Decoding is the process of converting written letters and words into their corresponding sounds to read them correctly. It is a basic reading skill that helps a beginner reader recognise and pronounce unfamiliar words.

8. What is field-note? (2020)

A field-note is a written record made by an observer during or after direct observation of an event, behaviour, or situation, capturing details, reflections, and impressions for later study or analysis.

9. What is scanning reading? (2021, 2024)

Scanning is a fast reading technique used to quickly locate specific information (like a date, name, or fact) in a text, without reading every word. The eyes move quickly over the text to find the required detail.

10. State any two problems of reading. (2021)

- Poor vocabulary, which makes it difficult to understand the meaning of words in the text.
- Lack of concentration or slow reading speed, which affects comprehension and retention of the content read.

11. What do you mean by 'vocabulary'? (2021)

Vocabulary refers to the collection of words that a person knows and understands in a language, and can use while reading, writing, listening, or speaking. A strong vocabulary is essential for good reading comprehension.

12. What do you mean by reading fluency? (2021)

Reading fluency means the ability to read a text accurately, smoothly, and at a proper speed, with correct expression and intonation, allowing the reader to focus on understanding the meaning rather than decoding individual words.

13. What is 'Dyslexia'? (2021, 2024)

Dyslexia is a learning difficulty that mainly affects a person's ability to read accurately and fluently. It causes problems in recognising words, spelling, and decoding, though it is not related to a person's overall intelligence.

14. Define 'Critical Reading'. (2021)

Critical reading is an active, analytical way of reading in which the reader questions, evaluates, and judges the ideas, arguments, and evidence presented in a text, instead of simply accepting the content as it is.

15. What is 'Reading Skill'? (2021)

Reading skill is the ability to look at written text, decode the words, and understand their meaning correctly. It includes sub-skills like word recognition, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension, all working together for effective reading.

16. What is meant by SQ3R Technique(s)? (2022, 2024)

SQ3R stands for Survey, Question, Read, Recite, and Review. It is a reading comprehension method – first previewing the text, forming questions, reading actively to answer them, reciting the key points, and finally reviewing the material.

17. State two disadvantages of silent reading. (2022, 2023)

- It may lead to subvocalization, where the reader mentally pronounces words, which can slow down reading speed.
- There is no auditory reinforcement of information, which some learners may need for better understanding and retention.

18. What is Phonetic Method of Reading? (2022)

The Phonetic Method teaches readers to connect letters or letter combinations with their specific sounds (sound-symbol correspondence). Learners decode unfamiliar words by sounding them out letter by letter, which is fundamental for beginner readers.

19. Who is / Define Expert Reader. (2022, 2024)

An expert reader is one who reads fluently, accurately, and with full comprehension, using appropriate strategies (like skimming, scanning, or SQ3R) automatically and effectively to understand and analyse any text with ease.

20. Write two disadvantages of Silent and Loud reading. (2023)

- Silent reading: May cause subvocalization and reduced auditory reinforcement, slowing comprehension for some readers.
- Loud reading: It can be tiring, slower for silent understanding, and may disturb others while reading in a shared space.

21. What is passive and active vocabulary? (2023)

Passive vocabulary refers to words a person understands while reading or listening but does not normally use. Active vocabulary refers to words a person understands and confidently uses correctly while speaking or writing.

22. Mention two differences between Intensive and Extensive reading. (2023)

- Intensive reading involves careful, detailed study of a short text focusing on language and structure; extensive reading involves reading longer texts for overall meaning and enjoyment.
- Intensive reading builds accuracy and vocabulary; extensive reading builds fluency and reading speed.

23. What is SCROL technique? (2023)

SCROL is a reading comprehension strategy standing for Survey headings, Connect, Read, Outline, and Look back. It helps readers actively organise and remember information in a text, especially textbook material with headings and subheadings.

24. What is Skimming? (2023)

Skimming is a fast reading technique used to quickly get the general idea or gist of a text, without reading every word. The reader glances over headings, first lines, and key words to understand the overall content.

25. Mention the characteristics of Empirical Text. (2023)

Empirical texts are based on facts, direct observation, or experimental evidence rather than opinion. They present data, findings, and logical analysis, and are commonly found in research reports and scientific writing.

26. What do you mean by active vocabulary? (2024)

Active vocabulary refers to the words a person not only understands but can also confidently and correctly use while speaking and writing, as opposed to words only recognised while reading or listening (passive vocabulary).

27. What is meant by comprehension reading skill? (2024)

Comprehension reading skill is the ability to understand, interpret, and make meaning from a written text – going beyond just decoding words to grasping ideas, relationships, and the overall message of the content.

GROUP B – 5 Marks Questions (Answer within 150 words)

1. Explain two aspects of 'Descriptive Reading'. (2020, 2021)

- Descriptive reading involves reading a text that describes people, places, objects, or events in detail, helping the reader form a clear mental picture.
- One aspect is sensory detail – descriptive texts use vivid words appealing to sight, sound, and feeling, helping readers visualise the content clearly.
- Another aspect is sequential/organised presentation – descriptive reading often follows a logical order (e.g., spatial or chronological) so that the description builds up systematically.
- It requires the reader to actively imagine and connect details rather than just decode words.
- This type of reading is common in literature, travelogues, and observational reports, and it develops the reader's imagination, focus, and appreciation of detail.

2. Explain with relevant examples: 'prospective reflection'. (2020)

- Prospective reflection means thinking ahead about a future action, situation, or task before actually doing it.
- It involves anticipating possible outcomes, problems, and planning strategies in advance.
- Example: A teacher planning tomorrow's lesson thinks in advance about which teaching method to use, what difficulties students may face, and how to handle them — this is prospective reflection.
- Another example: Before giving a public speech, a person mentally reflects on how to structure it and how the audience might react.
- This differs from retrospective reflection (thinking back on a past experience), as prospective reflection is forward-looking and helps in better preparation and decision-making.

3. Discuss two techniques which are applicable for developing vocabulary for reading. (2020, 2022)

- Contextual guessing: Encouraging readers to guess the meaning of unfamiliar words from the surrounding sentence or context, instead of always using a dictionary. This builds independent reading skill.
- Wide/extensive reading: Reading a variety of texts (stories, newspapers, articles) regularly exposes readers to new words repeatedly in different contexts, helping vocabulary grow naturally.
- Other useful techniques include using flashcards, word-mapping (writing synonyms, antonyms, and usage), and regular dictionary/thesaurus use for unfamiliar words.
- Group discussions and vocabulary games can also make new word learning more interactive and memorable.
- Together, these techniques help learners build both passive (recognition) and active (usage) vocabulary over time.

4. What are the differences between oral and silent reading? / loud and silent reading? (2020, 2024)

- Oral reading involves reading aloud, using the voice; silent reading involves reading internally, without speaking.
- Oral reading is generally slower, as pronunciation takes time; silent reading is faster since it skips vocalization.
- Oral reading helps develop pronunciation, fluency, and is useful for group/classroom teaching; silent reading is more suitable for personal study and deep comprehension.
- Oral reading can disturb others in a shared space; silent reading can be done anywhere without disturbing others.
- Oral reading is commonly used with beginner readers to build confidence; silent reading is preferred by mature, independent readers for concentration and speed.

5. What do you mean by skimming and scanning? / Differentiate between skimming and scanning reading. (2020, 2022)

- Skimming is a fast reading technique used to get the general idea or overview of a text, by glancing at headings, introductions, and key sentences, without reading every word.
- Scanning is a fast reading technique used to search for specific information (like a date, name, or number) in a text, moving the eyes quickly until the required detail is found.
- Skimming answers "What is this text about?", while scanning answers "Where is this specific information?"
- Skimming is used before detailed reading to get an overview; scanning is used when looking for a particular fact (e.g., finding a phone number in a directory).
- Both are useful time-saving reading strategies for quickly handling large amounts of text.

6. Mention the utilities / benefits of extensive reading. (2021, 2024)

- Extensive reading means reading large amounts of text (books, articles, stories) for overall meaning, enjoyment, and general understanding, rather than detailed study.

- It builds reading fluency and speed, as the reader practices reading continuously without stopping at every word.
- It expands vocabulary naturally, as new words are encountered repeatedly in different contexts.
- It improves general knowledge and comprehension ability across various topics and text types.
- It builds reading habit and interest, making reading an enjoyable activity rather than a difficult task.
- It also improves writing skills indirectly, as exposure to good sentence structure and style influences the reader's own expression.

7. Write a key note on 'Developing Reading comprehension'. (2021)

- Reading comprehension is the ability to understand and interpret meaning from a written text.
- It can be developed through techniques like previewing the text, predicting content, and asking questions before and during reading.
- Building vocabulary is essential, as understanding word meanings directly supports understanding the whole text.
- Practising summarising and retelling the content in one's own words helps check and strengthen understanding.
- Using strategies like SQ3R (Survey, Question, Read, Recite, Review) and SCROL helps readers actively engage with and remember the text.
- Regular practice with varied texts (stories, reports, articles) at appropriate difficulty level gradually improves comprehension over time.

8. Discuss two techniques for developing reading comprehension. (2021)

- SQ3R Technique: Survey the text first, form Questions about it, Read actively to find answers, Recite/summarise the key points, and Review the material – this structured method builds strong understanding.
- Contextual and Inferential Questioning: Asking "why," "how," and prediction-based questions while reading encourages the reader to think beyond the literal text and connect ideas, improving deeper comprehension.
- Other useful techniques include summarising paragraphs after reading and discussing the text with others to check understanding.
- Vocabulary building alongside these techniques ensures that comprehension is not blocked by unfamiliar words.
- Regular, guided practice with these techniques gradually makes comprehension automatic and effective for the reader.

9. What are the levels of reading? Discuss about any one of them. / Analyze different levels of reading with suitable examples. (2021, 2023)

- The main levels of reading are: Elementary reading (basic word recognition), Inspectional reading (skimming to get an overview), Analytical reading (thorough, detailed understanding), and Syntopical/Comparative reading (comparing multiple texts on the same topic).
- Elementary reading: The most basic level, where a reader learns to recognise letters, words, and read simple sentences correctly – typically developed in early school years.
- Inspectional reading: Involves quickly going through a text (skimming) to understand its general theme, useful when time is limited, e.g., quickly checking a newspaper article.
- Analytical reading: A detailed, careful reading to fully understand meaning, structure, and arguments in a text, e.g., studying a textbook chapter for an exam.
- Syntopical reading: The highest level, where a reader compares and analyses multiple texts on the same subject to form a broader understanding, e.g., comparing different books on a historical event.

10. Discuss the importance of reading across curriculum. (2022)

- Reading is not limited to the language subject; it is essential for understanding every subject in the curriculum, including Science, Mathematics, and Social Science.
- It helps students access, understand, and interpret information presented in textbooks across all subjects.
- Strong reading skills improve comprehension of word problems in Mathematics and complex concepts in Science.
- It builds vocabulary and background knowledge that supports learning in Social Science and language subjects together.
- Reading across the curriculum also develops critical thinking, as students learn to analyse information from different subject areas.
- Because all learning ultimately depends on reading ability, it is considered central and important across the entire school curriculum, not just in language classes.

11. Write the characteristics of ideal reading with examples. (2022)

- Fluency: The reader reads smoothly and at an appropriate speed without unnecessary pauses, e.g., reading a paragraph without stumbling over words.
- Accuracy: Words are pronounced and recognised correctly, e.g., correctly reading difficult or unfamiliar words using decoding skills.
- Comprehension: The reader understands the meaning of the text and can explain or summarise it, e.g., retelling the main idea of a story after reading.
- Expression: Proper intonation, stress, and pauses are used, especially in oral reading, to reflect the meaning and emotion of the text.
- Concentration: The reader stays focused, avoiding distraction, to fully grasp the content being read.
- These characteristics together define an ideal or "good" reader, who can read efficiently and understand deeply at the same time.

12. Discuss, in brief, the problems of reading. / Discuss in brief the problems of reading. (2022, 2024)

- Poor vocabulary: Limited word knowledge makes it difficult to understand the meaning of a text.
- Weak decoding skills: Difficulty in recognising and sounding out unfamiliar words slows down reading.
- Lack of concentration: Distraction or short attention span affects comprehension and retention while reading.
- Reading disorders like Dyslexia: Specific learning difficulties can affect accurate and fluent reading, regardless of intelligence.
- Lack of background knowledge: Unfamiliarity with the topic makes it harder to understand and connect ideas in the text.
- Poor reading habits: Subvocalization, regression (re-reading words unnecessarily), and slow reading speed are common problems that reduce reading efficiency and comprehension.

13. Elucidate necessary activities to develop reading skill. (2023)

- Regular practice: Daily reading of varied texts (stories, newspapers, textbooks) builds fluency and confidence over time.
- Read-aloud sessions: Practising oral reading helps improve pronunciation, fluency, and expression.
- Vocabulary-building activities: Using new words in context, maintaining a word list, and playing word games expand vocabulary.
- Guided comprehension exercises: Answering questions, summarising, and discussing texts strengthen understanding.

- Use of reading strategies: Teaching techniques like skimming, scanning, SQ3R, and SCROL helps readers approach texts more effectively.
- Silent and loud reading practice: Both types of reading should be practised to develop different reading abilities.
- Exposure to varied text types: Reading narrative, descriptive, and expository texts helps develop flexible and well-rounded reading skill.

14. Name two types of texts with example. Mention the characteristics of each text. (2023)

- Narrative text: Tells a story with characters, setting, and a sequence of events, e.g., a short story or novel. Characteristics: has a plot, characters, and follows a beginning-middle-end structure; often includes dialogue and description.
- Expository text: Explains or informs the reader about a topic using facts and logical organisation, e.g., a science textbook chapter. Characteristics: uses clear structure (definitions, examples, cause-effect), objective tone, and factual content rather than imaginative elements.
- Other examples include descriptive text (creates a vivid picture using sensory details) and empirical text (based on observation/data).
- Recognising the type of text helps readers choose the right reading strategy – narrative texts are read for enjoyment and sequence, while expository texts are read for information and understanding.

15. Discuss any two strategies to develop metacognitive skills to enhance comprehension and retention. (2023)

- Self-questioning: The reader asks themselves questions before, during, and after reading (e.g., "What do I already know?", "Does this make sense?") to monitor their own understanding actively.
- Summarising and self-review: After reading a section, the reader pauses to summarise it in their own words and checks whether they understood it correctly, helping identify gaps in comprehension.
- Other strategies include using the SQ3R method (which builds in planning, questioning, and reviewing) and think-aloud techniques, where readers verbalise their thinking process while reading.
- These strategies make the reader consciously aware of their own thinking, allowing them to correct misunderstandings early and retain information for a longer time.

16. Mention the problems of reading a text. Suggest remedial measures to overcome those problems. (2023)

- Problems: Poor vocabulary, weak decoding skills, lack of concentration, reading disorders like dyslexia, lack of background knowledge, and poor reading habits (subvocalization, regression).
- Remedial measure for poor vocabulary: Regular vocabulary-building exercises, wide reading, and use of context clues.
- Remedial measure for weak decoding: Practising phonetic method, breaking words into syllables, and repeated reading practice.
- Remedial measure for concentration issues: Reading in a quiet environment, setting short reading goals, and using guided/timed reading exercises.
- Remedial measure for dyslexia or specific difficulties: Individualised, multisensory teaching methods and extra support from trained teachers.
- Remedial measure for poor habits: Training readers to avoid word-by-word reading and regression through practice with techniques like skimming and paced reading.
- With consistent practice and the right strategies, most common reading problems can be significantly reduced or overcome.

17. Explain narrative, descriptive and conceptual texts. (2024)

- Narrative text: Presents a story or sequence of events involving characters and a plot, usually with a beginning, middle, and end, e.g., a short story or a fable.
- Descriptive text: Focuses on describing a person, place, object, or event in vivid detail, using sensory words to help the reader visualise it clearly, e.g., a travel description.
- Conceptual text: Explains ideas, theories, or concepts in an organised way, often used in academic or textbook writing to build understanding of abstract topics, e.g., a chapter explaining a scientific concept.
- Each text type requires a slightly different reading approach – narrative for following sequence and characters, descriptive for imagination and detail, and conceptual for logical understanding and analysis.

18. Briefly describe the process of reading. (2024)

- Reading begins with visual perception – the eyes recognise letters and words on the page.
- This is followed by decoding – converting the written symbols into sounds and recognisable words.
- Next is word recognition and vocabulary access – connecting the decoded word with its stored meaning in memory.
- Then comes comprehension – combining word meanings to understand phrases, sentences, and the overall message of the text.
- Finally, the reader engages in interpretation and reflection – relating the content to prior knowledge, forming opinions, and remembering key information.
- This entire process, from seeing print to understanding meaning, happens rapidly and often simultaneously in a skilled/expert reader.

Note: Questions worded slightly differently across years but testing the same concept have been merged into one entry with all applicable years mentioned, to avoid repetition.